Teenage Mutant Ninja Turtles Report: Learned Archetypes, Bombs, and Synergies

MTGNET

October 27, 2026

Dataset Snapshot

This run on Teenage Mutant Ninja Turtles uses 39,488 unique deck builds and 180,204 game rows. The unsupervised clustering stage produced 6 learned archetypes. Card win rates are games-in-hand (GIH) win rates; an archetype's win rate is over all of its games. The best-performing large shells are Five-Color Pizza | Everything Pizza / Frog Butler, Orzhov | Oroku Saki, Shredder Rising / April O'Neil, Kunoichi Trainee, Izzet Robots | Nobody / Mouser Foundry, which already tells us that the format is not a single monolithic color table: it separates into distinct deck families with their own signposts, core cards, and standalone bombs.

How to Read This Report

- **Coreness** measures how central a card is to an archetype: played in many of its decks, characteristic of it, and connected to the rest of the deck. Cards are grouped into Core, Support and Periphery rings. A core card may carry a tag: **signature** (in bold: played in at least 15% of this archetype's decks and in at most one other archetype at that rate) or *staple* (at least 25% of this archetype's decks and at least 15% in three or more archetypes); untagged core cards are neither.
- **Play rate** is the share of the archetype's decks that play at least one copy.
- **Bombs** are cards that are strong on their own. A bomb's **lift** compares, within the decks that play it, the win rate when the card is in hand with the win rate when it stayed in the library, relative to a typical card of the archetype, and is shrunk across archetypes; it is shown in percentage points (pp). Bombs are listed whatever ring they sit in: core and support bombs keep their ring on the site, and only bombs that would otherwise be peripheral go to the bomb island beside the rings.
- A **synergy pair** wins more often when both cards are drawn than their separate effects predict (games-in-hand, adjusted for game length and play/draw). The effect λ is an interaction log-odds, shown as a percentage change in the odds of winning with its 95% confidence interval. Pairs are tested with Benjamini–Hochberg false-discovery control: *verified* means $q \leq 0.10$, *tentative* means $q \leq 0.25$. Few pairs pass; an absent pair means "not detectable with this data", not "no synergy".

- **Payoff** and **engine** roles are decided by synergy arrows only: the synergy pairs (verified or tentative) whose direction is significant. In such a pair the arrow points from the payoff, the card that wins more when drawn without its partner, to the engine it rewards; a card whose arrows mostly point out of it is a payoff, one whose arrows mostly point into it an engine. The arrow reflects each card's standalone strength within the pair, not a direction of the synergy itself. Played-together links carry the same arrow on the site as context only; they do not set roles.

1 Discovered Archetypes

Archetype	Decks	Games	WR	Top signposts
Five-Color Pizza | Everything Pizza / Frog Butler	4,511	20,474	60.34%	Everything Pizza, Frog Butler, Courier of Comestibles, Omni-Cheese Pizza, Ragamuffin Raptor
Orzhov | Oroku Saki, Shredder Rising / April O'Neil, Kunoichi Trainee	9,328	44,722	58.56%	Oroku Saki, Shredder Rising, April O'Neil, Kunoichi Trainee, Foot Ninjas, Leonardo, Big Brother, Squirrelanoids
Izzet Robots | Nobody / Mouser Foundry	10,016	46,737	57.67%	Nobody, Mouser Foundry, Donatello, Turtle Techie, Buzz Bots, Sewer-veillance Cam
Boros | Raphael, Tough Turtle / EPF Point Squad	4,521	19,830	55.32%	Raphael, Tough Turtle, EPF Point Squad, The Neutrinos, Go Ninja Go, Leonardo, Big Brother
Golgari | Ragamuffin Raptor / Michelangelo, Game Master	6,557	29,432	54.32%	Ragamuffin Raptor, Michelangelo, Game Master, Tenderize, Frog Butler, Primordial Pachyderm
Simic | Genghis Frog / Tenderize	4,555	19,009	52.11%	Genghis Frog, Tenderize, Lessons from Life, Slithering Cryptid, Frog Butler

2 Core of Each Archetype

The core ring of each archetype, most central first, with the share of the archetype's decks that play each card and its tag where it has one: **signature** (in bold) or staple. The second line lists the archetype's bombs, whatever ring they sit in: cards that are strong on their own, with their lift (in-hand vs in-library win rate within the decks that play them, relative to a typical card of the archetype, shrunk across archetypes) and their games in hand.

Archetype	Core cards (play rate)
Izzet Robots 10,016 decks	**Mouser Foundry** (75%, signature), **Mouser Mark III** (52%, signature), Manhole Missile (68%, staple), **Utrom Scientists** (43%, signature), Nobody (78%, staple), Return to the Sewers (62%, staple), **General Traag, Heart of Stone** (37%, signature), **Brilliance Unleashed** (52%, signature), Donatello, Turtle Techie (74%, staple), **Baxter Stockman** (51%, signature) *Bombs:* Sally Pride, Lioness Leader (+10.4 pp, 380 games); Mighty Mutanimals (+6.9 pp, 646 games); April O'Neil, Hacktivist (+6.5 pp, 3,052 games); Agent Bishop, Man in Black (+6.5 pp, 543 games)
Orzhov 9,328 decks	**Oroku Saki, Shredder Rising** (72%, signature), **Squirrelanoids** (60%, signature), **Foot Ninjas** (63%, signature), **Leonardo, Big Brother** (66%, signature), **Featherbrained Filcher** (37%, signature), **Splinter, Hamato Yoshi** (40%, signature), **Uneasy Alliance** (60%, signature), **Karai's Technique** (45%, signature), **April O'Neil, Kunoichi Trainee** (72%, signature), **Karai, Future of the Foot** (44%, signature) *Bombs:* Sally Pride, Lioness Leader (+14.3 pp, 2,479 games); Dream Beavers (+11.0 pp, 9,406 games); Mighty Mutanimals (+10.4 pp, 8,131 games); Triceraton Commander (+7.9 pp, 1,574 games)
Golgari 6,557 decks	Michelangelo, Game Master (60%, staple), Tenderize (64%, staple), Zoo Escapees (48%, staple), Primordial Pachyderm (60%, staple), Anchovy & Banana Pizza (64%, staple), Ragamuffin Raptor (67%, staple), **Tainted Treats** (47%, signature), Frog Butler (69%, staple), **Pizza Face, Gastromancer** (46%, signature), Ice Cream Kitty (58%, staple) *Bombs:* The Last Ronin (+11.3 pp, 1,819 games); Armaggon, Future Shark (+9.1 pp, 1,957 games); Agent Bishop, Man in Black (+7.1 pp, 507 games); Sally Pride, Lioness Leader (+6.8 pp, 481 games)
Simic 4,555 decks	Michelangelo, Game Master (56%, staple), **Genghis Frog** (58%, signature), **Lessons from Life** (51%, signature), Slithering Cryptid (58%, staple), Tenderize (68%, staple), **Crustacean Commando** (36%, signature), **Venus, Torn Between Worlds** (31%, signature), Frog Butler (67%, staple), Zoo Escapees (39%, staple), Return to the Sewers (60%, staple) *Bombs:* The Last Ronin (+11.4 pp, 510 games); Armaggon, Future Shark (+8.9 pp, 329 games); April O'Neil, Hacktivist (+6.4 pp, 1,270 games); Michelangelo, Weirdness to 11 (+5.9 pp, 1,511 games)
Boros 4,521 decks	**Raphael, Tough Turtle** (76%, signature), **Leonardo, Big Brother** (62%, signature), **The Neutrinos** (55%, signature), **Go Ninja Go** (51%, signature), **April O'Neil, Kunoichi Trainee** (64%, signature), **EPF Point Squad** (62%, signature), **Jennika, Bad Apple Big Sister** (56%, signature), **Uneasy Alliance** (58%, signature), **Action News Crew** (49%, signature), **Mutant Town Musicians** (33%, signature) *Bombs:* Sally Pride, Lioness Leader (+17.1 pp, 1,317 games); Mighty Mutanimals (+9.9 pp, 4,216 games); Agent Bishop, Man in Black (+8.2 pp, 1,139 games); Raphael, the Nightwatcher (+8.0 pp, 1,310 games)
Five-Color Pizza 4,511 decks	Courier of Comestibles (53%, staple), Primordial Pachyderm (56%, staple), Ragamuffin Raptor (61%, staple), Omni-Cheese Pizza (62%, staple), Frog Butler (77%, staple), **Everything Pizza** (81%, signature), **Lessons from Life** (47%, signature) *Bombs:* The Last Ronin (+12.5 pp, 858 games); Frog Butler (+7.4 pp, 10,299 games); Sally Pride, Lioness Leader (+6.8 pp, 595 games); Armaggon, Future Shark (+6.8 pp, 1,187 games)

3 What Defines the Best Shells

Five-Color Pizza | Everything Pizza / Frog Butler

This cluster contains 4,511 decks across 20,474 games and posts a baseline win rate of 60.34%. Its core (the cards most central to it) is `Courier of Comestibles` (53% of decks), `Primordial Pachyderm` (56% of decks), `Ragamuffin Raptor` (61% of decks), `Omni-Cheese Pizza` (62% of decks), `Frog Butler` (77% of decks). Its defining signposts are `Everything Pizza`, `Frog Butler`, `Courier of Comestibles`, `Omni-Cheese Pizza`, `Ragamuffin Raptor`, `Lessons from Life`.

Bombs that win on their own here: `The Last Ronin` (+12.5 pp), `Frog Butler` (+7.4 pp), `Sally Pride, Lioness Leader` (+6.8 pp). Out of 496 card pairs tested, 0 are verified synergies (BH $q \leq 0.10$) and 2 tentative ($q \leq 0.25$). The strongest tentative pair is `Genghis Frog` + `New Generation's Technique`: +102% odds of winning when both are drawn (95% CI [+32, +209]%, 140 games). Among its synergy pairs with a significant direction, the engines they reward are `New Generation's Technique`.

Orzhov | Oroku Saki, Shredder Rising / April O'Neil, Kunoichi Trainee

This cluster contains 9,328 decks across 44,722 games and posts a baseline win rate of 58.56%. Its core (the cards most central to it) is `Oroku Saki, Shredder Rising` (72% of decks), `Squirrelanoids` (60% of decks), `Foot Ninjas` (63% of decks), `Leonardo, Big Brother` (66% of decks), `Featherbrained Filcher` (37% of decks). Its defining signposts are `Oroku Saki, Shredder Rising`, `April O'Neil, Kunoichi Trainee`, `Foot Ninjas`, `Leonardo, Big Brother`, `Squirrelanoids`, `Uneasy Alliance`.

Bombs that win on their own here: `Sally Pride, Lioness Leader` (+14.3 pp), `Dream Beavers` (+11.0 pp), `Mighty Mutanimals` (+10.4 pp). Out of 496 card pairs tested, 1 are verified synergies (BH $q \leq 0.10$) and 2 tentative ($q \leq 0.25$). The strongest verified pair is `Featherbrained Filcher` + `Oroku Saki, Shredder Rising`: +38% odds of winning when both are drawn (95% CI [+24, +53]%, 3,005 games).

Izzet Robots | Nobody / Mouser Foundry

This cluster contains 10,016 decks across 46,737 games and posts a baseline win rate of 57.67%. Its core (the cards most central to it) is `Mouser Foundry` (75% of decks), `Mouser Mark III` (52% of decks), `Manhole Missile` (68% of decks), `Utrom Scientists` (43% of decks), `Nobody` (78% of decks). Its defining signposts are `Nobody`, `Mouser Foundry`, `Donatello, Turtle Techie`, `Buzz Bots`, `Sewer-veillance Cam`, `Manhole Missile`.

Bombs that win on their own here: `Sally Pride, Lioness Leader` (+10.4 pp), `Mighty Mutanimals` (+6.9 pp), `April O'Neil, Hacktivist` (+6.5 pp). Out of 496 card pairs tested, 1 are verified synergies (BH $q \leq 0.10$) and 5 tentative ($q \leq 0.25$). The strongest verified pair is `Mouser Mark III` + `Utrom Scientists`: +20% odds of winning when both are drawn (95% CI [+9, +33]%, 3,270 games).

Boros | Raphael, Tough Turtle / EPF Point Squad

This cluster contains 4,521 decks across 19,830 games and posts a baseline win rate of 55.32%. Its core (the cards most central to it) is `Raphael, Tough Turtle` (76% of decks), `Leonardo, Big Brother` (62% of decks), `The Neutrinos` (55% of decks), `Go Ninja Go` (51% of decks), `April O'Neil, Kunoichi Trainee` (64% of decks). Its defining signposts are `Raphael, Tough Turtle`, `EPF Point Squad`, `The Neutrinos`, `Go Ninja Go`, `Leonardo, Big Brother`, `Old Hob, Alleycat Blues`.

Bombs that win on their own here: `Sally Pride, Lioness Leader` (+17.1 pp), `Mighty Mutanimals` (+9.9 pp), `Agent Bishop, Man in Black` (+8.2 pp). Out of 496 card pairs tested, 0 are verified synergies (BH q $\leq$ 0.10) and 1 tentative (q $\leq$ 0.25). The strongest tentative pair is `Mighty Mutanimals` + `Uneasy Alliance`: +30% odds of winning when both are drawn (95% CI [+11, +53]%, 1,299 games).

4 Bombs: Cards That Are Good Alone

Cards flagged as bombs in at least one archetype, whatever ring they sit in on the site, each shown in the archetype where its lift is largest. *Lift*: within the decks that play the card, the win rate when it is in hand vs when it stayed in the library, relative to a typical card of the archetype, shrunk across archetypes. *Raw lift*: the card's games-in-hand win rate minus the archetype baseline, not shrunk.

Card	Archetype	Lift	Raw lift	GIH WR	Games
`Sally Pride, Lioness Leader`	Boros	+17.1 pp	+15.1 pp	70.46%	1,317
`The Last Ronin`	Five-Color Pizza	+12.5 pp	+17.3 pp	77.62%	858
`Dream Beavers`	Orzhov	+11.0 pp	+8.1 pp	66.69%	9,406
`Mighty Mutanimals`	Orzhov	+10.4 pp	+8.3 pp	66.86%	8,131
`Armaggon, Future Shark`	Golgari	+9.1 pp	+10.4 pp	64.74%	1,957
`Agent Bishop, Man in Black`	Boros	+8.2 pp	+8.2 pp	63.56%	1,139
`Raphael, the Nightwatcher`	Boros	+8.0 pp	+4.2 pp	59.54%	1,310
`Triceraton Commander`	Orzhov	+7.9 pp	+6.1 pp	64.61%	1,574
`Frog Butler`	Five-Color Pizza	+7.4 pp	+6.3 pp	66.60%	10,299
`April O'Neil, Hacktivist`	Izzet Robots	+6.5 pp	+7.3 pp	65.01%	3,052
`Michelangelo, Weirdness to 11`	Simic	+5.9 pp	+9.2 pp	61.35%	1,511
`Mikey & Don, Party Planners`	Golgari	+5.8 pp	+9.0 pp	63.35%	1,315
`Dark Leo & Shredder`	Orzhov	+5.6 pp	+5.3 pp	63.84%	2,193
`Don & Leo, Problem Solvers`	Boros	+5.3 pp	+3.2 pp	58.56%	444

5 Build-Arounds and Shell Dependence

Card	Best cluster	Shell dependence	Support delta	Supported games
Featherbrained Filcher	Orzhov | Oroku Saki, Shredder Rising / April O'Neil, Kunoichi Trainee	10.0 / 10	59.32 pp	7519
Oroku Saki, Shredder Rising	Orzhov | Oroku Saki, Shredder Rising / April O'Neil, Kunoichi Trainee	9.3 / 10	15.03 pp	17054
Utrom Scientists	Izzet Robots | Nobody / Mouser Foundry	8.4 / 10	15.37 pp	10190

6 Dependency Cards

Card	Best cluster	Dependency	Standalone lift	Games
Oroku Saki, Shredder Rising	Orzhov | Oroku Saki, Shredder Rising / April O'Neil, Kunoichi Trainee	0.320	0.90 pp	17063
Featherbrained Filcher	Orzhov | Oroku Saki, Shredder Rising / April O'Neil, Kunoichi Trainee	0.320	0.73 pp	7522
Mouser Mark III	Izzet Robots | Nobody / Mouser Foundry	0.185	-1.15 pp	13573
Utrom Scientists	Izzet Robots | Nobody / Mouser Foundry	0.185	-2.31 pp	10195
Frog Butler	Five-Color Pizza | Everything Pizza / Frog Butler	0.000	6.26 pp	10299
Everything Pizza	Five-Color Pizza | Everything Pizza / Frog Butler	0.000	5.39 pp	9538
Ragamuffin Raptor	Five-Color Pizza | Everything Pizza / Frog Butler	0.000	2.34 pp	7119
Omni-Cheese Pizza	Five-Color Pizza | Everything Pizza / Frog Butler	0.000	2.90 pp	7108
Primordial Pachyderm	Five-Color Pizza | Everything Pizza / Frog Butler	0.000	3.09 pp	6730
Courier of Comestibles	Five-Color Pizza | Everything Pizza / Frog Butler	0.000	6.51 pp	6081

Card	Best cluster	Dependency	Standalone lift	Games
Tenderize	Five-Color Pizza | Everything Pizza / Frog Butler	0.000	3.87 pp	5390
Sewer-veillance Cam	Five-Color Pizza | Everything Pizza / Frog Butler	0.000	3.14 pp	5343

7 Best Draft Priorities

Card	Best cluster	Pick score	Draft win lift	Rarity
Dream Beavers	Orzhov | Oroku Saki, Shredder Rising / April O'Neil, Kunoichi Trainee	10.0 / 10	2.67 pp	uncommon
Mighty Mutanimals	Orzhov | Oroku Saki, Shredder Rising / April O'Neil, Kunoichi Trainee	10.0 / 10	2.85 pp	uncommon
Casey Jones, Jury-Rig Justiciar	Izzet Robots | Nobody / Mouser Foundry	10.0 / 10	2.13 pp	uncommon
Sally Pride, Lioness Leader	Orzhov | Oroku Saki, Shredder Rising / April O'Neil, Kunoichi Trainee	9.9 / 10	5.87 pp	rare
The Last Ronin	Golgari | Ragamuffin Raptor / Michelangelo, Game Master	10.0 / 10	6.29 pp	mythic
Courier of Comestibles	Golgari | Ragamuffin Raptor / Michelangelo, Game Master	10.0 / 10	2.27 pp	uncommon
Metalhead	Izzet Robots | Nobody / Mouser Foundry	10.0 / 10	1.96 pp	uncommon
Brilliance Unleashed	Izzet Robots | Nobody / Mouser Foundry	10.0 / 10	1.44 pp	uncommon
Everything Pizza	Five-Color Pizza | Everything Pizza / Frog Butler	10.0 / 10	1.11 pp	uncommon
Tainted Treats	Golgari | Ragamuffin Raptor / Michelangelo, Game Master	9.9 / 10	1.53 pp	uncommon
Frog Butler	Five-Color Pizza | Everything Pizza / Frog Butler	10.0 / 10	0.92 pp	common
Mouser Foundry	Izzet Robots | Nobody / Mouser Foundry	9.6 / 10	0.92 pp	common

8 Verified Synergy Pairs

Every pair below passed a pair-interaction test on games-in-hand data, stratified by game length and play/draw, with Benjamini–Hochberg false-discovery control across all pairs tested in its archetype. λ is the interaction log-odds, shown as the change in the odds of winning when both cards are drawn, with its 95% confidence interval. Across all archetypes, 2 pairs are verified ($q \leq 0.10$) and 11 tentative ($q \leq 0.25$, marked †).

Pair	Archetype	Odds	95% CI	q	Pair WR	Games
Featherbrained Filcher + Oroku Saki, Shredder Rising	Orzhov	+38%	[+24, +53]%	<0.001	63.59%	3,005
Mouser Mark III + Utrom Scientists	Izzet Robots	+20%	[+9, +33]%	0.020	56.33%	3,270
Oroku Saki, Shredder Rising + Stomped by the Foot	Golgari	+26%	[+11, +44]%	0.126†	59.60%	1,735
Genghis Frog + New Generation's Technique	Five-Color Pizza	+102%	[+32, +209]%	0.155†	73.57%	140
Courier of Comestibles + New Generation's Technique	Five-Color Pizza	+74%	[+25, +143]%	0.155†	73.81%	252
Mighty Mutanimals + Uneasy Alliance	Boros	+30%	[+11, +53]%	0.187†	65.82%	1,299
Leonardo, Sewer Samurai + Squirrelanoids	Orzhov	+49%	[+14, +95]%	0.195†	70.39%	412
Grounded for Life + Squirrelanoids	Orzhov	+18%	[+6, +32]%	0.195†	58.36%	2,553
Everything Pizza + Nobody	Izzet Robots	+29%	[+8, +55]%	0.203†	66.24%	1,330
General Traag, Heart of Stone + Mouser Foundry	Izzet Robots	+15%	[+4, +27]%	0.203†	63.60%	4,294
April O'Neil, Hacktivist + Manhole Missile	Izzet Robots	+25%	[+6, +46]%	0.227†	70.64%	1,427
Retro-Mutation + Utrom Scientists	Izzet Robots	+18%	[+4, +33]%	0.227†	56.45%	1,798
Mechanized Ninja Cavalry + Mind Transfer Protocol	Izzet Robots	+16%	[+4, +29]%	0.227†	61.50%	2,452

9 Anti-Synergies Worth Respecting

Pairs whose interaction is significantly negative ($q \leq 0.10$): they win less often when drawn together than their separate effects predict.

Pair	Archetype	Odds	95% CI	Pair WR	Games
High-Flying Ace + Koya, Death from Above	Orzhov	-23%	[-33, -12]%	54.24%	1,274
Mighty Mutanimals + Quintessential Katana	Orzhov	-23%	[-33, -10]%	61.90%	1,050

Pair	Archetype	Odds	95% CI	Pair WR	Games
Foot Ninjas + Karai, Future of the Foot	Orzhov	-19%	[-27, -10]%	56.07%	2,802
Bespoke B? + Sewer-veillance Cam	Izzet Robots	-17%	[-25, -8]%	57.83%	2,995
Mechanized Ninja Cavalry + Mouser Foundry	Izzet Robots	-17%	[-24, -9]%	60.55%	5,870
Baxter Stockman + Mouser Foundry	Izzet Robots	-16%	[-23, -8]%	62.31%	6,017
Casey Jones, Jury-Rig Justiciar + Mechanized Ninja Cavalry	Izzet Robots	-16%	[-24, -7]%	62.25%	3,070
Foot Ninjas + Jennika, Bad Apple Big Sister	Orzhov	-16%	[-24, -7]%	54.73%	3,037
Mouser Foundry + Sewer-veillance Cam	Izzet Robots	-15%	[-21, -8]%	62.09%	9,382

10 Bottom-Line Reading

This report treats the format as a deck ecosystem rather than a flat card ranking. Each archetype is described first by its core: the cards that are played in most of its decks, characteristic of it and connected to the rest of the deck. Bombs are listed separately because they win on their own and are worth taking (and often splashing) whatever the shell. Synergy claims are deliberately conservative: only pairs that survive a false-discovery-controlled interaction test are reported, with their effect size and confidence interval, so the short pair list is a feature of honest statistics rather than a lack of interplay between the cards.